precision-use governmental beneficiary lists with last-mile political workers to initiate a concerted campaign of political mobilisation that broke new ground in north Indian politics.

Yogi Adityanath's November 2018 village chaupal gathering in Pratapgarh (described in Chapter 1) was one such meeting. When he started that late-night assembly by asking people if they had received scheme benefits, the loudest voices in the crowd shouted 'no'. The initial response seemed to indicate that the vast majority of people in the village had not received anything. But once the chief minister read out some beneficiary lists himself, asked the DM and the DPRO to read out other lists and engaged in public dialogue with those who had grievances, it turned out that more than half the village had indeed benefited. 'On labharthees, the issue is that, when someone gets something, mostly they keep quiet,' a senior government officer who works closely with Yogi Adityanath's office explained later. 'You see any political rally, say of Modi's. When the camera shows labharthees, they don't show any obvious reaction. They keep sitting quietly. When the guys in front clap, they will all clap. If they don't clap, then no one will clap. It will look like whatever is being said does not concern them.' In that first Pratapgarh chaupal, he and some of his officers deliberately mingled with the audience and sat with them. His account of the crowd dynamic is worth repeating in full:[23]

Whenever Yogi would ask a question about schemes, we saw that there were essentially fifteen–twenty boys who, each time, would shout 'nahin' [no]. They must have had a problem with the village pradhan and they kept saying that he ate all the toilets, that he was a thief. They insisted they hadn't got anything. The vast majority was silent because whosoever gets anything, they usually keep quiet. Many don't tell anyone it is from the government. They tell people they got it with their own money or from the family. That is why they keep quiet. We were worried because it was a large crowd and people were watching from rooftops and had climbed trees. A chief minister dealing with such a bawaal [disturbance] is rare. But Yogiji is used to street politics.